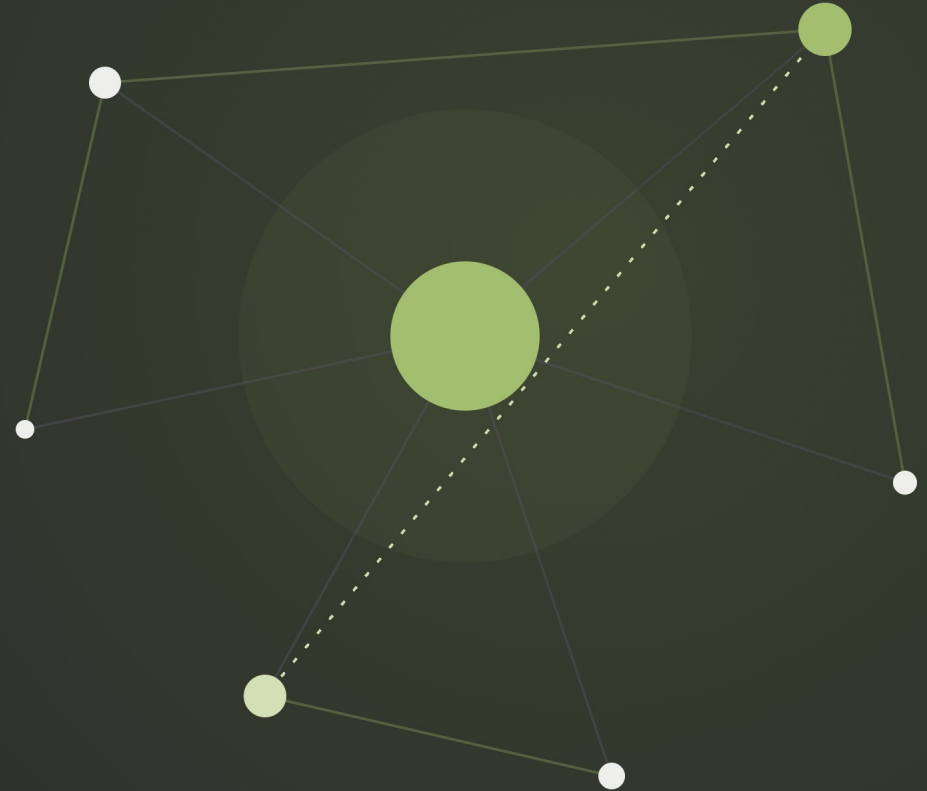


CHALLENGE 03 • OPEN SOURCE

The Influence Atlas

Who is really shaping the world's rules? Start with Europe. Build it in a day. We publish it.

MADRID OPEN • MAD TECH CAMPUS • 03.10.2026



THE MISSION

**Build the first open,
public map of who
shapes the world's
laws. Start with
Europe, then go global.**

The best work becomes an open-source project and a public report on who influences European law, published under your names.

WHY THIS ONE

The hardest challenge of the day, and the one that lives on

FOR YOU

Your names on it

Authors of a public report and maintainers of an open-source project that outlives the day.

FOR REVERSA

A problem we work on every day

We will publish the result, keep building on it in the open and bring the best people closer to the team.

FOR EVERYONE

Rules we all live by

Who shapes them is public, but nobody can read it at scale. You make it visible to anyone.

THE CHALLENGE

Influence Atlas

Which companies and people actually get their way inside the laws, and who will next?

NO LEGAL BACKGROUND NEEDED

REVERSA × MADRID OPEN

HOW EU LAW IS MADE

The European Commission proposes a law and opens a public consultation where anyone can send comments. Members of the European Parliament propose changes, called amendments. A final text comes out. Every step is public.

WHAT A LOBBY IS

Any company, association or NGO that tries to shape a law. In the EU they must register, and their submissions and meetings are published.

THE SCALE

Not one law: all of Europe, from 2019 to today. Thousands of submissions, thousands of amendments, one graph of who shaped what.

THE TRAP

Legal text is full of standard phrases, so similar wording proves nothing. Real influence is usually reworded, and that is what we want you to catch.

Five questions it must answer

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- | | |
|--------|---|
| 01 WHO | Which companies, associations and people influence EU law the most? |
|--------|---|
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- | | |
|---------|--|
| 02 WHAT | On which topics: AI, energy, finance, health, food, transport, and more? |
|---------|--|
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- | | |
|------------|--|
| 03 TOWARDS | Pushing for what, and does it match what they say in public? |
|------------|--|
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- | | |
|--------|--|
| 04 HOW | Through which channels: consultations, meetings, MEPs, coalitions, timing? |
|--------|--|
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- | | |
|---------|--|
| 05 NEXT | Who is rising, and what will they win in the coming years? |
|---------|--|
-

WHAT YOU BUILD

Four layers, from raw texts to a public atlas

01 · MAP

The graph

Actor → ask → amendment
→ final article across EU law
since 2019, enriched with
public positions.

02 · RANK

Who wins

Companies, associations
and people ranked by real
wins, by topic and by year.

03 · EXPLAIN

Towards what, and how

What each actor says in
public versus what it asks
in private, and the playbook
that wins.

04 · FORECAST

The next years

Who is rising and fading, and
which asks will land in laws
being negotiated now.

WHAT YOU HAND IN

A graph we can explore live, a short public report answering the five questions, and an open-source repo anyone can rerun.

Start with the record. Then go beyond it.

01 • WHAT THEY ASK

The EU record

- EU Transparency Register: who lobbies, budgets, files
- Meeting registers and Integrity Watch EU
- Have Your Say: every consultation submission
- Legislative Observatory and committee amendments
- HowTheyVote.eu, EUR-Lex, LobbyFacts.eu

02 • WHAT THEY SAY

Their public voice

- Company and association websites, position papers
- Press releases and op-eds
- Social media posts from companies, executives and MEPs
- News coverage, for example through GDELT

03 • THEN GO GLOBAL

Beyond Europe

- US lobbying disclosures (lda.senate.gov)
- National lobby registers and parliaments
- The same actors, followed across borders

The magic is in the comparison: what an actor says in public, what it asks in private, and what actually ends up in the law.

The bar we will judge against

Piece	Weak	Great
The graph	Organisations linked because they share words.	Every edge shows its evidence: the ask, the amendment, the final article.
Who wins	The biggest spenders, which the register already tells you.	Who actually gets their way, even when it is not who spends most.
Towards what, and how	A list of topics.	The positions each actor pushes and the playbook that works for them.
The next years	A chart of the past.	Who is rising, on what, and what they will win next, with reasons.
The report	A dashboard only your team can read.	A report a journalist could publish tomorrow.

HOW WE SCORE IT • 100 POINTS

Checked live, in front of you

Criterion	What we check at your demo	What great looks like
Real links • 25	We pick 3 links from your graph at random and read both texts side by side.	All three are real influence, not shared standard wording.
Any law • 20	We name an EU law on the spot. Your system shows who shaped it, with no code changes.	Results on screen in minutes, and they hold up.
Insight • 25	We read your answers to the five questions.	Something non-obvious that we can check on the spot.
Report • 15	We read your report and open your repo.	Publishable as it is, and anyone can rerun it.
Ambition • 15	How much of Europe you cover, and your forecast.	Everything since 2019, with a reasoned view of what comes next.

THE RULES

Nothing prepared, on purpose

NO DATA

We hand out nothing: no dataset, no labels. Finding the data is part of the challenge.

ALL PUBLIC

Only public sources, so everything you find can be published.

OPEN SOURCE

Your code goes in a public repo with an open licence, so the atlas lives on.

TEAMS

Three or four people. Your own models, editors and agents.

FREEDOM

Found a better angle on who shapes the world's laws? Take it.

THE DAY

Saturday, 09:00 to 21:00

09:00

Kickoff and teams confirmed.

09:30

Find your data and build.

19:30

Live demos, [5] minutes each, with the jury's checks.

21:00

Winners announced.

THE PRIZE

Each member of the winning team picks a book from the Reversa shelf, lunch with the founders, and your names on the public report.

CHALLENGE 03 • THE INFLUENCE ATLAS

**Show the
world who
writes its
laws.**